

Coming in 2006....

World Center for Peace and Sustainability: Basic plan

Brian O'Leary, September, 2005, Vilcabamba, Ecuador

"La verdad es salvaje"

1. **Vision Statement** We pledge to do everything in our power to transform global wars and ecocide into a new context of preservation, restoration and sustenance of the Earth's biosphere for future generations. We believe that the practice of art, new science, spirit, and the visioning of a just, peaceful and sustainable world pave the way for the needed global future. To these ends, we establish the International Center for Peace and Sustainability near the village of Vilcabamba, Ecuador.
2. **The Setting** Our mountainside retreat is located on more than two acres of lush tropical gardens with clean air, waterfalls, rainbows, and spectacular views of the Andes of Podocarpus National Park. Below us is the village itself, one mile away in the Valley of Longevity, famed for its healing waters. Across the valley we see the legendary mountain Mondango where almost daily the sunsets are awesome, changing colors by the second at our equatorial site. We are a mile above sea level, blessing this paradise with an ideal year-round climate with day temperatures in the seventies and dropping into the sixties at night. Food is local fresh organic produce. The hotels are affordable and nice. The natural ambiance here is contagious. Some visitors have called our site "the most beautiful spot on Earth I have ever seen."
3. **The Buildings** Two main buildings comprise over 6000 square feet, most of which will be used for the center. It will also include the residence of the founders, Dr. Brian O'Leary and his artist wife Meredith Miller. The new, larger building now under construction will be open for Center activities in 2006.
4. **Our Mission** We emphasize education, activism, research, think-tanks and informed dialogues on new paradigms that would lift us out of our global fix. The center will eventually become a university. We invite conscious teachers, leaders and students to come to the Center to participate in forums on creating sensible transition scenarios and goals for a global paradigm shift, unfettered by the daily pressures of urban and vested institutional settings. Our varied programs include art workshops, music, drama, weekend or week-long workshops (some keyed into tour groups and guest faculty visits) and public events in the arts, lectures and dialogues on pressing long-term regional and global issues.
5. **Programs-**
 - * Retreats (like the Esalen Institute or Sivananda yoga ashrams) with guest teachers and students coordinated with tour groups
 - * *Seminars and Sunsets*, our late afternoon programs (bring your camera)
 - * Art workshops with Meredith Miller- including painting on location at sacred sites, quaint villages, and magic mountain vistas
 - * New science and new energy workshops with Dr. Brian O'Leary
 - * Yoga retreats and classes
 - * Concerts
 - * Puppet shows, renaissance theatre, humor
 - * Community events
 - * Ceremonies with indigenous peoples and shamans
 - * Astronomy deck and possible UFO sightings

6. The Founders

Brian O'Leary, Ph.D., 65, author, world teacher and activist, was a NASA astronaut during the Apollo program and served on the faculties of Cornell, Princeton, Hampshire College, and U.C. Berkeley in astronomy, energy science and science policy assessment. He was special staff consultant on energy for the U.S. House Interior Committee and advisor to Morris Udall and other U.S. presidential candidates. He was also a leading peace activist during the Vietnam War and a citizen diplomat during Soviet Glasnost. He is author of many popular books, most recently *Re-Inheriting the Earth: Awakening to Sustainable Solutions and Greater Truths*. In 2003, he founded the New Energy Movement, a grass-roots non-profit organization advocating research into innovative energy sources for a sustainable global future. In his spare time, Brian plays the piano, teaches yoga, photographs nature, and performs puppetry and cartooning. www.brianoleary.com

Meredith Miller, 59, is an internationally acclaimed, prize-winning visionary artist and art

teacher for over forty years, with hundreds of paintings that hang on walls throughout the world. Much of her art is alchemical, containing the soil essences from sacred sites she has visited globally. Basically Meredith paints dreams. According to testimonies of dozens of her collectors, her powerful images in watercolor, oil and mixed media have evoked healings, ancient wisdoms, new relationships, or discovery of that special spot in nature. Her dedication to beautifying the Center can be felt throughout the land and the buildings.
www.meredithmillerart.com

7. **Logistics** The Center is one full day's travel to and from most of North, Central and South America, although an overnight stop in Quito or Guayaquil is sometimes necessary. Daily jets fly to and from our local city Loja and Quito, and every other day between Loja and Guayaquil. Such frequent access plus an inexpensive taxi ride from and to the airport on good roads, make travel convenient. We recommend the artistic and affordable Madre Tierra Hotel for local accommodations, located just two miles from the Center, with fresh daily organic breakfasts and dinners served. Travel can also include group packages with tours of Machu Picchu, the Galapagos, the Amazon jungle and other attractions.

"The truth is wild. We need not fear embracing it"

Given the proper settings and practices, we can better understand and celebrate the wisdom of nature and the value of sustainability. It is increasingly obvious to many of us in the industrialized West that the elaborate public relations (propaganda) machines in virtually every institution and field no longer represent greater truths, but instead are myths of reality based on false or narrow assumptions. When our quest for truth becomes so distorted through contemporary human filters and suppressions, we must take a breath and look at nature, to *imitate* nature. We then can then begin to embrace a kind of *wild truth*, or natural law. This could lead to the context for innovation and restoration of community towards a new global republic and a declaration of interdependence whose values are peace, sustainability and social justice. The eagle and condor can then join in peace.

We hope that a combination of the idyllic pastoral setting and our programs will help bring us to a more creative and conscious understanding the dilemmas of and solutions to world challenges.